Student Support & Well-being Resources at ETH Zurich

This page collects information published by ETH Zurich about student support and well-being. It brings together ETH services, student-led support, and external helplines referenced in ETH resources. The original sources are linked below and in the Sources section for further details and current contact information.

If you are facing a difficult period - whether it is personal, academic, or professional - **you do not have to handle it alone**.

Emergency & Immediate Safety (24/7)

If you are in immediate danger, experiencing acute violence, or facing a life-threatening mental health crisis, use these numbers right away:

- **Police:** 117
- **Ambulance:** 144
- **International Emergency:** 112
- **ETH Emergency (Threats/Violence):** +41 44 632 30 30 (or internal 2 30 30)
- **Crisis Intervention Unit Zurich:** +41 58 384 20 00
- **Aerztefon (Emergency Psychiatrist/Doctor):** 0800 33 66 55

Harassment, Bullying & Violence

ETH enforces a strict zero-tolerance policy against inappropriate behavior.

- **Respect Office:** The primary internal hub for personal counseling, case classification, and coaching regarding bullying, discrimination, and sexual harassment.
  - Website & Contact Info
  - Email: respect@ethz.ch
- **ETH Whistleblowing System:** An encrypted, secure platform where you can report misconduct completely anonymously.
  - Secure Reporting Portal
- **SSHE Threat Management:** To report targeted intimidation, stalking, threats, or physical violence.
  - Email: threatmanagement@ethz.ch

Burnout, Depression & Mental Health

If you are experiencing exhaustion, constant stress, low mood, or anxiety, reach out to professional counseling services:

- **Psychological Counseling Services UZH/ETH:** A dedicated, professional team offering free, strictly confidential short-term counseling. They help with stress, depression, exam anxiety, and can guide you toward long-term psychotherapy if needed. Available in English, German, French, and Italian.
  - Website & Appointment Booking
- **ETH Counselling & Coaching Centre (StS):** Provides practical support for navigating academic pressure, time management, motivational slumps, and unique studying circumstances.
  - Website

Student-Led & External Helplines (Anonymous)

Sometimes it is easier to talk to a peer or someone entirely outside the university infrastructure:

- **Nightline Zurich:** An anonymous, confidential hotline and chat service run by students, for students, operating during the semester.
  - Phone: +41 44 633 77 77
  - Website
- **Die Dargebotene Hand:** A confidential Swiss hotline offering emotional support 24/7.
  - Phone: 143
- **Heart2Heart Hotline:** English-speaking telephone support available daily from 6 PM to 11 PM.
  - Phone: 0800 143 000

Sources

- ETH Zurich: Emergency contacts
- ETH Zurich: Support when faced with inappropriate behaviour or conflict
- ETH Zurich: Anonymous notices
- ETH Zurich: Threat management
- ETH Zurich: Mental health counselling contacts
- ETH Zurich: Counselling & Coaching Centre
- ETH Zurich D-ITET: Welcome information for doctoral students (PDF, including psychological counselling and helplines)